public name. If you see `!Ref NameOfSomething`, think of it as a placeholder for what is referenced by the name. A `!GetAtt 'NameOfSomething.AttributeOfSomething'`, shown in the next code, is similar to a ref but you select a specific attribute of the referenced resource.

**Listing 4.15 CloudFormation outputs example**

```
Outputs:
  ID:
    Value: !Ref Server                              ①
    Description: 'ID of the EC2 instance'
  PublicName:
    Value: !GetAtt 'Server.PublicDnsName'           ②
    Description: 'Public name of the EC2 instance'
```

① References the EC2 instance

② Gets the attribute PublicDnsName of the EC2 instance

You'll get to know the most important attributes of `!GetAtt` while reading this book.

Now that we've taken a brief look at the core parts of a CloudFormation template, it's time to make one of your own.

## *4.5.2 Creating your first template*

How do you create a CloudFormation template? Different options are available, as shown here:

- Use a text editor or IDE to write a template from scratch.
- Start with a template from a public repository that offers a default implementation, and adapt it to your needs.
- Use a template provided by your vendor.

AWS and its partners offer CloudFormation templates for deploying popular solutions: AWS Partner Solutions at